TrAItors

Shift the blame. Survive the night shift. — a single-player social-deduction game inspired by *The Traitors*

GitHub Game Off 2026 · Theme: SHIFT · Deadline 1 Dec 2026, 13:37 PST (21:37 UK) · TypeScript + Phaser, HTML5 build on itch.io

SHIFT

Pitch

You are the Traitor in a mansion of six to eight AI Faithfuls. Each day you roam the rooms, plant evidence, build alibis and seed rumours. Each evening the Round Table votes someone out. Each night you kill. Survive to the end without being banished. **Shift** is the one key that matters: hold it to sneak through the halls, hold it to lie at the table.

Theme interpretation

- **Shift the blame** — the core verb. Frame, plant, misdirect.
- **Shifting alliances** — a visible trust web between portraits that redraws after every vote.
- **Night shift** — murders happen on the night shift; alibis are about who was on duty where.
- **The Shift key** — sneak in the mansion, lie in dialogue. One key, reinforced everywhere.

Core loop (one in-game day)

1. DAY Free roam	2. ROUND TABLE Accuse & vote	3. NIGHT Choose a victim
Limited action budget (~90s or 6 actions). Plant evidence, chat, seed doubt, ally, bribe. Avoid sight cones; hold Shift to sneak.	NPCs read sightings, evidence and testimony. Suspicion scores drive speeches and the vote. Hold Shift to lie — every lie is logged.	Pick who dies and *where*. The body's room is a clue you chose to leave. Day counter advances; schedules reshuffle.

The mansion (free roam)

- One floor, 8–12 rooms, Tiled tilemap, top-down sprites. No stairs, no outdoors.
- NPCs follow daily room schedules on fixed paths (fade between rooms; no pathfinding).
- Sight cones = tiny stealth game. Being seen somewhere at the wrong time is recorded as a *sighting*.
- Sightings are remembered imperfectly per archetype — that gap is what you exploit.
- Evidence pool of ~6 items (letter, key, bloodied cloth, photo…), each tagged *belongs to*.

Room interactions (menu-driven, 4 verbs)

- **Chat** — learn where they were and who they suspect.
- **Seed doubt** — "I saw Marcus near the cellar." Shifts their suspicion; costs you if exposed.
- **Ally** — propose voting together.
- **Bribe** — trade a mission reward for a vote.

Suspicion engine

Every NPC holds a suspicion score for every other player. Scores shift on: evidence found (weighted by *who* found it), sightings, voting history, who defended whom, and contradictions between statements. The player never sees raw numbers — only rumours overheard in rooms, body-language cues at the table, and the trust web redrawing.

- **Provenance matters:** plant the glove, then "find" it yourself and sharp NPCs suspect the finder. Engineer someone else into that room.
- **Rumour chains:** a doubt seeded in the kitchen can reach the table via two other mouths.

NPC archetypes (simple rules, emergent drama)

Detective	Remembers sightings exactly; cross-checks your logged lies.
Sheep	Votes with the majority; misremembers half of what it saw.
Loyalist	Protects one ally no matter what. Loves an alliance.
Grudge-holder	Votes against whoever accused them last. May lie about sightings.
Paranoid	Suspects whoever seems to be winning. Twitchy about alliances.

Win / lose

- **Lose:** banished at a Round Table.
- **Win:** outlast the Faithfuls (or reach final three undetected).
- **Stretch:** play as a Faithful — becomes a deduction puzzle; only after Traitor mode is tense.

Tech & scope

- **Phaser + TypeScript + Vite.** DOM overlays for dialogue, trust web and vote UI.
- Deterministic, templated NPC dialogue — no LLM, works offline on itch.io.
- Mini-games are optional. If kept: one "Mission" room, <60s, grants a Shield you must explain away.
- Risk: GitHub's own inspiration list includes a blame-shifting detective game. Differentiator = the social layer and the mansion.

Week-one MVP (grey boxes only)

8 rooms · 6 NPCs on schedules · sight cones · Shift-to-sneak · one plantable item · Round Table that reads sightings + evidence and votes · win/lose. **Test:** is creeping down a corridor while the Detective turns around already tense? If yes, spend weeks 2–4 on polish, art and audio.

Rough schedule

Wk 1	Tooling (1 day max), map, movement, NPC schedules, sight cones, suspicion core, vote.
Wk 2	Evidence & provenance, 4 room verbs, archetypes, night phase, trust web UI.
Wk 3	Art pass, Round Table dialogue templates, audio, lie logging, balance.
Wk 4	Playtest, tutorial, itch.io HTML5 build, push to GitHub, submit early.